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# H1. Overview

Colleges and institutes (including polytechnics) offer industry-related and professional programs of study leading to a wide range of degrees, diplomas, and certificates (see below for some examples). These institutions are very similar to Training and Further Education (TAFE) colleges in Australia and tend to focus on training and skills development through hands-on experience, often including a co-op component where a real-world work term related to the study program counts toward the credential.

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## Did You Know?

Colleges and institutes across Canada work in partnership with local businesses, communities, and industries to ensure that the curriculum reflects in-demand labour market needs. As a result, they offer programming that supports innovation across a number of key economic sectors. These include advanced manufacturing, agri-food, natural resources and clean tech, health and bioscience, digital technology, and social innovation. In 2019/20, **42,000** students contributed to applied research projects at college and institute laboratories and research centres. Their work and the state-of-the-art research infrastructure available help support innovation in various sectors of the economy. Here are just some examples of programs international students could choose from at colleges and institutes in Canada:

- 3D computer graphics
- Agriculture and agri-food
- Aviation and aerospace
- Business studies
- Broadcasting and journalism
- Culinary and nutrition

- Digital mapping
- Digital media and animation
- Early childhood education
- Electronic game design
- Engineering technology
- Environment and natural resources
- Genetics technology
- Health information management
- Health sciences
- Industrial education/skilled trades
- Information technology
- Renewable energies
- Social services
- Tourism and hospitality

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International students often say colleges and institutes feel comfortable since these institutions' small class sizes allow them to practise language skills and build friendships more easily with very strong support from centralised student services on and off campus. As well, they appreciate the access to industry-experienced faculty and co-op, internship, and other work placement opportunities, all of which lead to experience in the field of their choice that enables them to progress smoothly into their careers.

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